Name: .....

ID: .....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
All Branches
MTA Exam
2024-2025 /Spring
Date: 8 April 2025
2:30 – 4:00

er of Exam Pages: 9 ding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **1.5 hours**

RUCTION

are THREE sections in this exam paper:

re required to answer ALL the sections.

- In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering few analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
- In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a four-paragraph essay.
- In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, and end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
- Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
- Devote 5 minutes for reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questions.

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Initials & Signature
n I: Writing Focus & Editing	20	10		
n II: Essay Outlining	15	5		
n III: Essay Writing	55	15		
Total in Figures		30		
Total in Letters	90 Minutes	Thirty Marks		

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Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	10 POINTS	20 MINUTES

I. Choose the right answer from a, b, c or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which of the following is a correct sentence and avoids a fragment?

a. "The professor explained the concept. Which was very helpful."
b. "The students completed their assignments, which were due yesterday."
c. "She went to the store. To buy some groceries."
d. "The committee met in the conference room. Discussing the new policies."

2. Which of the following is an example of a parallel structure?

a. "She enjoys reading, writing, and to paint."
b. "He likes to run, biking, and swimming."
c. "They prefer hiking, camping, and fishing."
d. "The project involves researching, to analyse data, and presenting results."

3. Which of the following sentences correctly uses a transition to indicate contrast?

a. "The experiment yielded positive results; however, further research is needed."
b. "The study was difficult, moreover, the results were inconclusive."
c. "The professor explained the concept well, therefore, students understood it easily."
d. "The results were surprising, for instance, the data showed unexpected trends."

4. Choose the sentence with correct subject-verb agreement:

a. The dogs is barking loudly in the yard.
b. The teachers have completed their tasks on time.
c. The children was excited for the field trip.
d. The teacher complete the tasks on time.

5. Which of the following is the correct paraphrase of the sentence: "*The company's profits have increased significantly over the past year*"?

a. "The company's profits have gone down over the past year."
b. "The company has been making a lot of money this year."
c. "The company's profits have risen sharply in the last year."
d. "The company's profits have remained stable over the past year."

6. Which sentence best demonstrates coherence?

a. "The study was thorough. Results were clear. It provided valuable information."
b. "Study long. Results clear. Information important."
c. "The study was done, and results showed useful information."
d. "The study was conducted thoroughly, leading to clear and valuable results."

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7. Which of the following sentences maintains a formal tone suitable for academic writing?

a. "Pollution is bad, and we need to stop it right away."
b. "I think pollution is a big problem that affects everyone."
c. "Pollution stinks, and the government should totally fix it."
d. "Environmental pollution poses a serious threat to public health and requires immediate action."

8. Read the following introductory paragraph, and then select the most appropriate thesis statement.

Technology has become an essential part of modern education. Online platforms, interactive tools, and digital resources help students access information easily. However, relying too much on technology can impact students' critical thinking and social skills. Understanding the balance between technology and traditional methods is key to effective learning. .....

a. The use of technology in education has both positive and negative effects on students' learning and social development.
b. Technology improves education by providing access to information and interactive learning experiences.
c. Many schools use technology to make learning more engaging.
d. Technology is becoming more common in classrooms around the world.

9. Which of the following is the correct topic sentence for the thesis: "*Online education offers flexibility and accessibility, but it also presents challenges such as lack of interaction and reduced motivation*"?

a. "Online learning allows students to study at their own pace and from anywhere in the world."
b. "Many students prefer traditional classroom learning over online courses."
c. "Online education offers flexibility and accessibility, but it also presents challenges such as lack of interaction and reduced motivation."
d. "Some online courses offer video lectures to help students understand the material better.".

10. Read the paragraph below then choose the best concluding sentence.

Reading books is a great way to gain knowledge and improve language skills. It helps expand vocabulary, enhances creativity, and develops critical thinking. Books also allow readers to explore different cultures and perspectives. .....

a. Libraries offer a variety of books for all ages.
b. As a result, reading regularly can greatly benefit personal growth and education.

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c. Some people prefer reading e-books instead of printed books.
d. Many famous authors have written about different cultures.

Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	15 MINUTES

Outline ONE of the following topics by filling in the graphic organizer below. *(5 points)*

1. Write a cause-and-effect essay examining the effects of remote learning on students' academic performance and social development. Discuss causes such as limited teacher interaction, lack of peer communication, and technological barriers. Use studies and personal examples to strengthen your argument

2. Write a narrative descriptive essay about a journey to a place you had never been before. Describe the sights, sounds, and atmosphere of the destination. Reflect on how the experience broadened your perspective, exposed you to new cultures, and changed your understanding of the world. Use vivid descriptions and personal reflections to make your story engaging.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

_____

_____

Thesis statement:

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

_____

_____

Major supporting details:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

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Major supporting details:

Concluding Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

Section	3	Essay Writing	15 POINTS	55 MINUTES

Write a four-paragraph essay (300-350 words) on the same topic that you have outlined in the previous section. **(15 points)**

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